

philosophising; and there are two sides to a coin, as ensuring a revenue stream from a software that you have paid to develop, can be equally argued as an inalienable right of the companies that make the software. Are there any benefits for everyone who uses open source software?

Yes, there are. Open source software are licenced in a way that makes them legal to use as many copies of them as you want, and wherever you want. Open source software take up much less resources than their commercial counterparts, because they don't have any code for licencing, authentication, DRM, promoting other products, attached advertisements and the like. Most FOSS is entirely free of spyware and adware. Bug fixes are very regular, and you will not be stuck with a buggy version for a long time. Open source software and the formats they use are future proof. If you make a complicated 3D model, and save it in the source format of a commercial modelling software, and then twenty years down the line, the corporation that makes the software closes down, your files will be useless. Remember, that in that much time, the hardware that you ran the original software on will probably be hideously outdated. If your software is open source, such a thing can never happen, simply because a new wave of users will continue to maintain the software.

There will always be commercial software that are much better than the open source counterparts, and an equal number of open source software that are better than the various commercial counterparts. In the end, the decision to use them is up to the individual, and this Fast Track covers the important aspects of using open source software, that is how to build from source, modify the source, the different types of software available for professionals, and which Linux distro is ideal for your needs. Read on, and you will find out that using open source software is not as complicated or terrible as it seems. Once you are done, there are plenty of source codes available in the DVD for you to play around with.